

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Muslim identity: divergent ways in which Muslim identity is expressed through the ummah in the ceremonies to welcome a child; expectations about modesty, including divergent interpretations of dress Surah 24:30–31; the origins, categories and significance of the laws of halal and haram; how they are applied to laws of food and drink, and riba (usury).
4.2	The mosque: divergent understandings of importance of the mosque, the design and different religious features of mosques, and furniture and objects in the mosque and their use in the various activities that take place, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 2:39.
4.3	The divergent understandings of the use, significance, meaning and purpose of calligraphy within Islam, including as a rejection of idolatry with reference to Surah 21:51–62: the way it is used to express belief, and how it may be used in the mosque and other settings.
4.4	Shi'a obligatory actions: understandings and implications of encouraging others to do good (Amr bil Maruf), including Surah 42:23–26; discouraging others from doing bad (Nahy Anil Munkar), Tawallah and Tabarra; love for the Prophet Muhammad and his family and disdain for their enemies; divergent understandings of their importance for Muslims in different traditions of Islam today.
4.5	The significance of Sufi ways of life: the origins of Sufism, orders, saints, and practice today. Sufi practices of fasting, and dhikr (remembrance) with reference to Surah 13:28: the nature, history, importance and purpose of fasting and dhikr and divergent understandings of their importance for Muslims today.
4.6	The role and significance of a Sheikh/teacher in Sufism: divergent understandings of the importance of a relationship with a teacher, the purpose of the teacher; the history, teachings and contributions of teachers: al-Ghazali, such as in his work <i>Revival of Religious Sciences</i> , outlining the Qur'anic basis of Sufism, ibn al-'Arabi and Rabi'a al-'Adawiyya.
4.7	The divergent understandings of use, significance, meaning and purpose of dance, music and poetry within Islam with specific reference to Sufism: the way these are used to express belief, as a devotional act, and how they may be used in other settings; divergent interpretations of the use of dance and music in Islam, including their rejection by some and interpretations of Sahih al-Bukhari 15:70 and 69:494.
4.8	The work of one named Muslim charity working for relief of poverty and suffering in the United Kingdom, what it does and why, including reference to sadaqah and Surah 2:271–274.

Paper 1: Area of Study 1 – Study of Religion

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- The assessment is out of 102 marks.
- Students must answer all sections and all questions on the chosen religion.
- The paper may include short open, open response and extended writing questions.
- The paper will assess spelling, punctuation and grammar (SPaG) and use of specialist terminology and these will contribute a minimum of 5% of marks towards the overall weighting for this paper.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Synopticity will be assessed where students are required to bring together their knowledge and understanding of religion from across the course of study.

Sample assessment materials

Sample papers and mark schemes can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Religious Studies A Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.

Area of Study 2: Study of Second Religion

Area of Study 2A – Catholic Christianity

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Catholic Christianity as a lived religion in the United Kingdom and throughout the world.

There are two sections: Beliefs and Teachings; Practices.

Students will be expected to study Catholic Christianity within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Catholic Christianity with wider Christian perspectives as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.8)*
- The practice and significance of worship (2.2)*.

Students should recognise that Catholic Christianity is one of the many religious traditions in Great Britain, which also include Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism and Sikhism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should also recognise that within Catholic Christianity there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within the wider Christian tradition in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Orthodox, Protestant and other Christian traditions.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs and practices to Catholics today should be explored throughout the two sections.

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The Trinity: the nature and significance of the Trinity as expressed in the Nicene Creed; the nature and significance of the oneness of God; the nature and significance of each of the Persons individually: God as the Father, Son and Holy Spirit; how this is reflected in worship and belief in the life of a Catholic today.
1.2	Biblical understandings of God as a Trinity of Persons: the nature and significance of God as a Trinity of Persons, including reference to the baptism of Jesus (Matthew 3:13–17); the historical development of the doctrine of the Trinity, including reference to the First Council of Nicaea and the First Council of Constantinople.
1.3	Creation: the nature and significance of the biblical account of Creation, including Genesis 1–3; and how it may be understood in divergent ways in Christianity, including reference to literal and metaphorical interpretations; the significance of the Creation account for Catholics in understanding the nature and characteristics of God, especially as Creator, benevolent, omnipotent and eternal.
1.4	The significance of the Creation account in understanding the nature of humanity: the nature and significance of the nature of humanity being created in the image of God, including reference to Genesis 1–3 and divergent understandings of humanity’s relationship with Creation (dominion and stewardship); the implications of these beliefs for Catholics today.
1.5	The Incarnation: Jesus as incarnate Son, the divine Word, both fully God and fully human; the scriptural origins of this belief, including John 1:1–18 and its importance for Catholics today.
1.6	The events in the Paschal Mystery: Catholic teachings about the life, death, resurrection and ascension of Jesus, including reference to Luke 24; the redemptive efficacy of these events and their significance for Catholics today.
1.7	The significance of the life, death, resurrection and ascension of Jesus for Catholic beliefs about salvation and grace, including John 3:10–21 and Acts 4:8–12; the implications and significance of these events for Catholic practice today.
1.8*	Catholic beliefs about eschatology: life after death; the nature of resurrection, judgement, heaven, hell and purgatory, including reference to John 11:17–27 and 2 Corinthians 5:1–10; divergent Christian beliefs about life after death with reference to purgatory and the nature of resurrection; why belief in life after death is important for Catholics today.